neighborhoods in Staten Island, across the water from Manhattan, to write poems about them. … Lord [*sic*] is a mature poet in full command of her full craft; many of the poems here are classically austere, and even the more obviously message-ridden are tautly constructed."[84] An anonymous reviewer for *Booklist* writes of the ideological bent of the work, "She has been courageous in speaking her mind, in standing up as a witness. … The content is laudable; at least, if you agree with her."[85]

In either case, Lorde's movement across geography and history and her shifts in content and form work together. Similarly, Barbara Christian writes for the *San Francisco Chronicle* that as Lorde actually "moves through Germany, Grenada, Florida, New York, Lorde is irrevocably affected by events in South Africa, Chile, El Salvador, Russia—by women she meets as 'Sisters in Arms.'" Christian sees Lorde as outlining an approach to geography and history that is about reflection and transformation, and she shapes her review with inflections of Lorde's written discourse. She adds, "To change their pattern of life, those who 'left our dead behind us' must have rituals of healing, a 'lust for working tomorrow' … this ritual, this lust, this poetry is not a luxury. It is a necessity, Lorde says, if we are to survive."[86] Therefore poetry, like diaspora, is posited around its powers of connection and modes of healing that enable a mutually constitutive and communal form of survival.

Lorde's profound connection to divided Berlin continued to spawn possibilities for her and fellow writers. She stayed in regular contact with Schultz and with Afro-German women through letter writing. She applied for a DAAD fellowship for 1985, noting in a letter to the director that she would "like to develop my contacts with the Black German artistic community." In May 1988, on one of her return trips, Lorde addressed the Dream of Europe Conference organized in West Berlin, an event that was also significant to the early Afro-German movement. Again, for Lorde, poetry and diaspora are analogous concepts, and the time-space of the dream becomes a point of departure: "For most of my life I did not dream of Europe at all except as nightmare. … I was fifty years old before I came to Europe." Lorde's previous vision of Europe was transformed by her interactions and the connections she continued to cultivate after her first trip. Her fight for survival, and her Iscador treatments and self-care regimens, connected to her vision of what it meant to travel and change perspective at age 50. She adds, of her adjusted sense of place and purpose, "When I did, I